

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jun 2026 – present — Career transition; not currently employed. Applied econometrics work continued and published at raphaludwig.github.io

Economist, Macro Research | Vista Capital

Dec 2020 – May 2026

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil — full-time (100%).

- **Market analysis and macro coverage**

- Covered the Brazilian macro-political landscape, combining data monitoring, quantitative modelling and macro-political scenario analysis. Conducted field research in Brasília, engaging with policy actors to build and refine internal macroeconomic scenarios.
- Covered the European macro-political landscape, focusing on the Euro area and the UK, while extending coverage to Central and Eastern Europe when necessary. Analyzed the intersection of economic activity, inflation, fiscal risk, elections, and central bank policies.
- Ran the thematic coverages on Covid-19, supply-chain disruption, macroeconomic impacts of AI and other themes with macroeconomic and market impact.
- Produced and presented weekly sessions on relevant macro themes, and took part in the daily morning news call. Responsible for the first read on Brazil and Europe.

- **Quantitative modelling and applied research**

- Designed the architecture of the macro forecasting models, including a proprietary model-selection algorithm and an automated system for short- and medium-term projections.
- Replicated and adapted empirical work from central banks, academic papers, policy blogs and sell-side research reports.

- **Data infrastructure, automation and applied AI**

- Set up the Macro Research area from inception alongside chief economist Alexandre Maia, defining processes, analytical routines, data infrastructure and the research products used in the fund's daily workflow.
- Built a proprietary macroeconomic data platform, running in Docker on a Linux VM and later migrated to Prefect, with autonomous monitoring of updates, alerting and automated reporting.
- Maintained more than 250 internal routines for collecting, processing, validating and distributing global data, built for robustness, traceability and fast reaction to data releases.
- Built internal AI solutions with Claude Code, including dashboard and workflow automation, optimisation of routines and algorithms, and data infrastructure.

- **Training, technical leadership and talent development**

- Trained successive cohorts of interns in programming and macroeconomics, and collaborated on the applied research of several of them, including supervision of an undergraduate thesis.
 - Coordinated internal training on economics, programming, automation and applied AI, including a company-wide crash course on the use of AI and Claude Code.
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EDUCATION

MSc in Economics | PUC-Rio

Jan 2019 – Jul 2021

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil — full-time. Average grade (CR): 8.1/10.

- Dissertation: “On the Missing Disinflation Puzzle: A Data-Driven Approach”, supervised by Prof. Eduardo Zilberman and Prof. Marcelo Medeiros.
- Admitted through ANPEC, the national entrance examination for graduate economics programmes in Brazil, with a top-15 result nationally, which carried a full scholarship at PUC-Rio, my first-choice programme.
- Gap Jul 2017 – Dec 2018: full-time preparation for the ANPEC examination between the end of the BSc and the start of the MSc.
- The final dissertation phase (Dec 2020 – Jul 2021), spent awaiting the thesis defence, overlapped with full-time employment at Vista Capital.

BSc in Economics | PUC-Rio

Jan 2013 – Jul 2017

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil — full-time. Average grade (CR): 8.4/10.

- Member of the PET (Undergraduate Research Program) and PIBIC (Undergraduate Research Assistance) under Prof. Pedro Souza (Queen Mary University of London), working on forecasting models and machine-learning applications.
- Teaching assistant for TPE II (Quantitative Research Methods in Economics) , a course on programming applied to microeconomics, forecasting and time-series exercises.
- Undergraduate thesis: “Nowcasting Unemployment with Google Trends: Evidence from the Brazilian Labour Market”, supervised by Prof. Pedro Souza.

Abitur (German secondary school leaving qualification) | Escola Alemã Corcovado

1999 – 2012

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil — full-time, German-track programme. Abitur completed in 2012, among the top 3 of my year.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Quantitative macro research:** forecasting, nowcasting, short- and medium-term models, applied econometrics, machine learning and macro-political scenario analysis.
- **Programming and data:** R, MATLAB/Octave, Dynare, Git, Python, Microsoft Office.
- **Infrastructure and automation:** Docker, Linux/VMs, Prefect, Airflow, automated pipelines, Slack integrations, Shiny, Streamlit and JavaScript.
- **Applied research and AI:** replication of empirical work from central banks, academic papers and sell-side research reports; use of Claude Code for automation, refactoring and optimisation of routines.

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: native | English: C1 (advanced) | German: C1 (Abitur, Escola Alemã Corcovado) | Spanish: A2 (basic)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Participated on panels at PUC-Rio on macroeconomics and programming; coordinated research initiatives with students from different universities in partnership with Vista Capital.
- Federated volleyball player throughout my teenage years; team captain across several seasons.
- Ongoing interest in music, literature, cinema, photography, fine arts and philosophy, with participation in interdisciplinary courses and seminars.